The Hawks Contract

Private Information for Angel Rocket

Your name is Angel Rocket. You are the star center of the Kansas City Tornado, a middle-of-the-pack team in the Women's National Basketball Association (WNBA). It is the 2030 offseason. You entered the league shortly after the landmark 2026 collective bargaining agreement transformed WNBA salaries, and you have been playing for the Tornado for all three years of your professional career. You are presently deliberating on whether to pick up a renewal option to play for them next year for a flat $2.1 million salary. Privately, your agent has advised you that the Tornado, while happy to have you, is unlikely to agree to any re-negotiation of these terms.

You have faced a decision like this before. After your rookie season, the Tornado offered you an early extension at terms the people around you called "safe money." Nearly everyone urged you to take it. You declined, bet on yourself, and made All-WNBA the following season; the contract you ultimately signed — the one now up for renewal — paid you nearly double the early offer. The experience taught you to trust your own read of your value and your prospects, even when more cautious voices around you disagree.

Perhaps because of the publicity about your renewal deliberations, you and your agent received a phone call from the Philadelphia Hawks, a perennial contender. The Hawks present center, Cindy Hooper, is a veteran in the final phase of her career. On the phone, Hawks management put forward the possibility of paying you a $2.5 million dollar salary, saying they would like to sit down and discuss it further. Naturally, you are interested in the possibility of playing for a championship team. So you and your agent agreed to a meeting at Hawk's headquarters.

In preparing for the meeting with your agent, you discussed your optimism that the Hawks could win a championship with you on board. You put the chances of winning a championship with the Hawks at 60%. Your agent noted that, beyond increasing the chances of winning, the Hawks would also benefit from increased merchandizing (Angel Rocket t-shirts, etc.). Your agent estimated that Hawks merchandising profits would be $10 million if the Hawks win a championship and $5 million if they do not win a championship. You both agreed that it would be interesting to hear what the Hawks had to say about these matters.

Your contract with your agent stipulates that the agent receives 5% of any salary the agent negotiates on your behalf with the Hawks. Your agent would not share in any merchandising or championship bonus arrangements. Your agent would not receive any money if you stay with the Tornado, since this would simply extend the existing contract.

The above is private information and is not to be shown to either Hawks management or your Agent.

This note was prepared as the basis for class discussion rather than to illustrate either effective or ineffective handling of an administrative situation. The teams, players, and events depicted are fictional; references to the league's 2026 collective bargaining agreement reflect its publicly reported terms.

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